

DCIM — Delegated Cognition Integrity Module

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Independent Methodological Authority

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Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™

Architecture Family: Cognitive Governance Intelligence Architecture (CLIA®)

Operational Layer: Multi-Agent Cognition Governance Layer

Governed Space: Delegated Cognition Integrity

Category: AI & Interpretation

Subcategory: Delegated Cognition Governance

Type: Multi-Agent Cognition Integrity Module

Parent Standard: Multi-Agent Cognition Integrity Standard (MCIS)

Version: 1.0

Status: Canonical · Open Module

Origin Date: 3 June 2026

Compatibility: OOF Methodology OS ·

Multi-Agent Cognition Integrity Standard (MCIS) ·

Agent Cognition Integrity Standard (ACIS) ·

Operational Authority Integrity Standard (OAIS) ·

Cognitive Coordination Integrity Module (CCIM) ·

Runtime Integrity Standard (RIS) ·

INTEGROS® — Integrity Standard

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF

Protection: MIP — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition

Delegated Cognition Integrity Module (DCIM) defines the structural conditions under which cognition delegated between autonomous agents remains traceable, attributable, authority-aligned, governance-valid, and operationally coherent throughout delegation, transfer of responsibility, task distribution, reasoning transfer, and collective execution.

DCIM governs delegated cognition.

The module ensures that cognition transferred between agents does not become opaque, unaccountable, authority-confused, or operationally invalid.

A system satisfies DCIM only if:

- delegated cognition remains traceable
- delegation authority remains valid
- responsibility remains attributable
- delegation boundaries remain visible
- cognition transfer remains governable

- collective accountability remains preservable

A multi-agent cognition environment that cannot identify who delegated, received, modified, or executed delegated cognition does not satisfy DCIM.

Module Operational Role

DCIM defines the delegated-cognition governance layer of MCIS.

Its role is to preserve accountability and legitimacy whenever cognition moves between agents.

Module Operational Space

DCIM governs:

- delegated cognition
- cognition transfer
- task delegation
- reasoning delegation
- authority transfer
- accountability preservation
- delegation traceability
- cognition ownership transitions

The module applies wherever cognition responsibilities move between autonomous agents.

Module Function

The module applies wherever systems must preserve:

- accountable delegation
- traceable cognition transfer
- authority-valid delegation
- governance visibility
- operational legitimacy
- distributed accountability

Its function is to ensure that delegation remains governable rather than becoming a source of cognition opacity.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Delegation Object

The organization must define which cognition activities require delegation governance.

This may include:

- planning delegation
 - task delegation
 - reasoning delegation
 - workflow delegation
 - monitoring delegation
 - decision-support delegation
 - execution delegation
 - authority-based delegation
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2. Define Delegation Conditions

The system must define the conditions under which delegation remains valid.

This includes:

- authority requirements
- delegation eligibility requirements
- accountability requirements
- traceability requirements
- transfer-boundary requirements
- governance-valid delegation conditions

3. Define Delegation Degradation Detection Logic

The system must define how delegation integrity degradation is identified.

This may include:

- unattributable delegation
- authority conflicts
- responsibility ambiguity
- delegation-chain opacity
- unauthorized transfers
- cognition-ownership inconsistencies

4. Define Operational Response or Governance Logic

The system must define governance logic for delegation failures.

Governance response may include:

- delegation review
- authority validation
- accountability reassignment
- governance intervention
- escalation
- delegation restriction
- operational invalidation where required

5. Preserve Traceability & Restrict Invalid Conditions

The system must preserve reconstructable traceability of:

- delegation events
- authority transfers
- responsibility assignments
- cognition ownership changes
- governance interventions
- execution outcomes

A multi-agent cognition environment must not remain delegation-valid if materially significant cognition transfers cannot be traced, attributed, or governed.

Use Case 1 — Hierarchical Agent Organization

Scenario

A coordinating agent delegates planning, analysis, monitoring, and execution responsibilities to specialized operational agents.

Application

DCIM governs delegation legitimacy, accountability continuity, and cognition-transfer traceability throughout the organization.

Result

The environment gains stronger governance visibility, reduced accountability ambiguity, and improved operational legitimacy.

Use Case 2 — Autonomous Workflow Orchestration System

Scenario

A workflow orchestration environment dynamically distributes tasks, reasoning activities, and operational responsibilities across multiple autonomous agents.

Application

DCIM governs delegated cognition ownership, authority alignment, and accountability preservation during workflow execution.

Result

The organization gains stronger delegation transparency, improved governance control, and reduced risk of opaque cognition-transfer chains.

Canonical Closing Statement

Delegated Cognition Integrity Module (DCIM) defines the structural conditions under which cognition delegated between autonomous agents remains traceable, attributable, authority-aligned, governance-valid, and operationally coherent throughout delegation, transfer of responsibility, task distribution, reasoning transfer, and collective execution.

Collective cognition cannot remain valid if delegated cognition loses accountability. Delegated cognition therefore becomes a foundational integrity condition of governable multi-agent cognition.

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